

XNIX - Some commands to start off with

A. Mustafi¹

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¹abhijit@bitmesra.ac.in, Dept. of CSE, BIT Mesra

0.1 Some Basic UNIX Commands

UNIX (and now LINUX) offers a huge range of commands which provide tremendous power to the user. In general the format of a command in XNIX is written as

`command -options arguments`

Some absolutely basic commands to start off with are listed in the Table 1

Table 1: Some basic UNIX/LINUX commands

Command	Effect	Usage
echo	display a string	<code>echo <str></code>
passwd	change your password	<code>passwd</code>
who	find out about users	<code>who -Hu</code>
whoami	find out about yourself	<code>whoami</code>
tty	know about your terminal	<code>tty</code>
stty	view and set terminal characteristics	<code>stty -a</code> or <code>stty <param></code>
script	record your session	<code>script</code> and <code>exit</code>
clear	clear your screen	<code>clear</code> (watch out for the <code>tput</code> command also)
uname	know your username	<code>uname -n</code>
date	get today's date	<code>date</code> , (date is highly configurable!!)
cal	get a calendar	<code>cal</code> (highly configurable just like date)
man	get detailed help for a command	<code>man cmd</code>
apropos	find a command for a job	<code>apropos <job></code>
whatis	one line description for a command	<code>whatis <cmd></code>